Explanation and Data Sources

Projection period: Government Code section 65588, subdivision (f), specifies the RHNA projection period start is December 31 or June 30, whichever date most closely precedes the end of the previous RHNA projection period end date. SCAG's projection period starts June 30, 2029, and ends October 15, 2037.

1-5. Population, Group Quarters, Household Population, and Projected Households: Pursuant to Government Code section 65584.01, projections were extrapolated from Department of Finance (DOF) projections. Population reflects total persons. Group Quarter Population reflects persons in a dormitory, group home, institution, military, etc., that do not require residential housing. Household Population reflects persons requiring residential housing. Projected Households reflect the propensity of persons, by age-groups, to form households at different rates based on Census trends.

7. Projected Apartment-Style Student Households: DOF provides projections of the student population expected to reside in apartment-style student housing by the end of the projection period. Under the US Census Bureau definitions, all student housing owned, leased, or managed by a college or university, including apartment-style units, are classified as group quarters rather than as part of the household population. Because DOF household projections exclude the group quarters population, projected changes in the number of students living in apartment-style student housing are not captured in the baseline household forecast. HCD accounts for this by subtracting the student population residing in apartment-style student housing at the beginning of the projection period (2029) from the projected population at the end of the projection period (2037). The resulting net change in student population living in apartment-style student housing (10,195) is then converted into projected households using the age 15-24 headship rate of 6.94% percent, resulting in an adjustment of 708 projected households.

8. Total Projected Households at the end of the projection period (October 15, 2037).

9. Vacancy Adjustment: Pursuant to Government Code section 65584.01, subdivision (b)(1)(E), HCD applies a vacancy adjustment based on the region's current vacancy percentage to promote healthy market vacancies that facilitate housing availability and resident mobility. Healthy vacancy rates are 2% for owners and 7% for renters for metropolitan planning organization (MPO) regions (6% for renters in non-MPO regions). There are two methodologies utilized to calculate this adjustment. The first methodology is to calculate the vacancy adjustment for existing households. The adjustment for existing households is the difference between the healthy rate of 2% and 7% vacancy rates and the region's current vacancy rates based on the 2024 5-year American Community Survey (ACS) data. That difference is then multiplied by the number of existing households by tenure based on the most recent occupied household estimates from DOF (existing households multiplied by current rates of renters and owners). For SCAG, the existing household owner vacancy rate (0.78%) is below the healthy standard, resulting in a 1.22% adjustment. The existing household renter vacancy rate (4.07%) is also below the healthy standard, resulting in a 2.93% adjustment. The second methodology is to calculate the vacancy adjustment for projected households. The projected household vacancy adjustment is obtained by applying the standard 2% and 7% vacancy rates to the projected owner and renter households. The healthy vacancy rates (2% and 7%) are then multiplied by the number of projected households